

The background of the page is a collage of images from the game Ninja Gaiden Sigma 2. On the left, a female character with a ponytail is shown in action. In the center, a large, dark Buddha statue is visible. On the right, a close-up of the main character, Ryu Hayabusa, wearing his signature mask and holding his sword. The title 'NINJA GAIDEN SIGMA 2' is prominently displayed in the center. A white box on the left contains review details, and a large yellow title 'Hack, Slash, Rehashed' is on the right.

Ninja Gaiden Sigma 2 Review

Reviewer: Faiyaz Shaikh

Genre: Action, Beat-em Up

Platform: PlayStation 3

Developer: Team Ninja

Publisher: Tecmo, Tecmo Koei

Price:

PlayStation 3- INR 2,799/-

WHAT WE LIKE

- Plenty of content
- Good replay value
- Rebalanced difficulty

WHAT WE HATE

- Recycled plot
- Poor voice acting and script

Hack, Slash, Rehashed

Tomonobu Itagaki has left the building and yet the show must go on. What's left of Tecmo's Team Ninja studio have gotten together to develop Ninja Gaiden Sigma 2 for the PlayStation 3 console. As most of you might have expected, Itagaki's departure has had a significant effect on some of the key elements of the game.

The Two Nin

You can either look at this game as a sequel to Ninja Gaiden Sigma, which was released on the PS3 in 2007 or you could call it as a port of Ninja Gaiden 2, an Xbox 360 exclusive released in June 2008. Whichever way you look at it, Ninja Gaiden on the PlayStation 3 is a very different beast compared to its Xbox version.

Even though the game retains the dismembering Obliteration moves from Ninja Gaiden 2, blood is a rare sight in this game. Most enemies (like Spider Ninjas) bleed some kind of glowing liquid of various hues while others have green blood or oil oozing out of their corpses. Overall, gore in the game has been drastically toned down.

Additionally, veterans of Ninja Gaiden on the Xbox will find Sigma 2 far easier to beat—almost a walk in the park. Enemy encounters in a chapter (or level) have been reduced and the number of enemies you find at a time on the screen is also low. In spite of more bosses in the game, the battles themselves are far easier to win as the damage done by the player is greater and no longer dependant on which body part is hit.

Ninja Dog

Playing on "Warrior" difficult level, which is the highest available during the first play-through, I was able to breeze through the first eight or nine chapters without the need to cast Nimpo (magic) or purchase any healing items. In fact, Nimpo feels more like an added luxury rather than an essential strategic addition to your arsenal as one can beat the game without ever casting Nimpo.

Ninja Gaiden games have always been reputed to be a difficult game to play, let alone master it and that has made it, to a certain extent, an elitist game. With rebalanced difficulty more people should be able to enjoy the awesomeness that is Ninja Gaiden since the game still retains its tight combat mechanics.